

7. AI for Research

Rice Business 2026

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The Research Loop, Assisted

Find

- Discover and track the literature
- Follow citations forward and back

Organize

- A private, searchable library of what you have read
- Search by keyword *and* by meaning

Write & review

- Draft and edit with field-aware guidance
- Referee your own work before a journal does

Draft outline — the four moves below are the arc of the session. Each maps to a tool you can install and use the same day.

Literature Search

Finding and Tracking Work

- Ask in plain language; get papers, not just links
- Discovery across OpenAlex and Semantic Scholar
- Track who cites a result, and what it cites
- *Placeholder: add a live example query*

Knowledge Databases

Your Own Library, Searchable

What it is

- A local, private store of your PDFs and notes
- Full-text plus semantic (meaning) search
- Import a Zotero library or a folder of PDFs

Why it helps

- “What do I have on X?” answered in seconds
- Notes tied to the papers that prompted them
- Export BibTeX straight into a paper

The `litdb` skill backs this. *Placeholder: demo adding a folder and running a hybrid search.*

Writing

Drafting and Editing

- Field-aware help for economics papers: structure, argument, clarity
- Rewrite passages to read as human, not machine-generated
- Keep the argument driving the structure, not a template
- *Placeholder: before/after on a real paragraph*

Reviews

Referee Before the Referee

- A rigorous, source-grounded referee report on a draft
- Separate editing notes and a prioritized revision plan
- Catch the objections a real reviewer will raise — first
- *Placeholder: run a review on a working paper*

Why This Belongs in Your Workflow

The judgment stays yours. AI handles the **search, the recall, and the first pass** — you decide **what matters and whether it is right.**

Breakout

Questions to Discuss

- Where in your own research does recall of the literature slow you down most?
- What would you keep in a private knowledge base that you would never put in a public tool?
- Which is riskier to hand to AI — the drafting, or the reviewing? Why?
- What would you need to see before you trusted an AI referee report?